- In September 1973, a source reported that a decision had been taken to cross the Suez Canal and occupy the crossings in an attempt to reach a diplomatic settlement.

Early Warnings—Potential Dates for the Launch of the War

From the vast intelligence material dealing with the potential dates of the expected war, the Mossad compiled seventy items containing clear warnings, all from important and highly valued sources. They were all based on HUMINT sources or on reports from the intelligence services of friendly foreign countries, indicating that contrary to what was understood from the discourse in the Israeli media, the warnings about the war were not based on a single source, namely Ashraf Marwan. The fulfillment of the intention to go to war was conditional on Egypt's readiness, which was not achieved before the middle of 1973. The desire and intention to go to war were present before then, of course, but the Mossad's sources clearly indicated that the realization of these intentions was far off or even nonviable, as the Egyptians were still in the preparation stage and did not consider themselves ready to go to war.

For example, while Sadat determined that 1971 was the "year of decision," according to a November 1971 report, he had informed the Soviets one month earlier that he still lacked critical munitions without which he could not start a war. These only began to make their way to Egypt in 1972. Another example: in November 1972, the Egyptian defense minister told the Syrians that Egypt wanted to go to war in January 1973. The Syrians said in response that they would not be ready before April 1973.

According to our sources, from the summer of 1972 three main times were discussed as possible times for the launching of the war: (a) late 1972 to early 1973; (b) between late April and early June 1973; and (c) September–October 1973. The fundamental differences between these three early warnings were as follows:

1. Regarding the first potential time, planning and preparations had not yet been completed and there were no reports of preparations on the ground.